Bow Valley College

Course Outline

ELLA0104

ELL Academic 4
Winter 2023 - Spring 2025

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ELLA0104 ELL Academic 4

COURSE DESCRIPTION

The Full-time Academic Program teaches language, settlement, and employment skills in the context of themes relevant to learners. This 15-week course aligns with the Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLBs) and focuses on reading, writing, listening, speaking. Academic 4 is part of Stage One of the CLBs and corresponds to basic English proficiency. In this stage, learners practice skills required to communicate in common, predictable situations about everyday activities and familiar topics. Learners exit the course with a CLB4. Instruction is learner-centered, task-based, and stresses community, education, and work-related language tasks. The program follows Portfolio-Based Language Assessment (PBLA) practices, focusing on what learners can do in English. Learners' progress is assessed by performance on a series of real-world tasks completed throughout the term and collected in their portfolio.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	16
HOURS	400
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	No
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning

8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Facilitate effective communication in a variety of real-world settings	1-10
2	Improve intelligibility (pronunciation, intonation, stress)	1-10
3	Increase comprehensibility (word choice, sentence structure, grammar)	1-10
4	Model intercultural competence in community and workplace contexts	1, 2, 3, 4, 6
5	Promote community orientation and engagement	9
6	Enrich learning with effective use of technology	5
7	Provide pathways to employment, workplace training, foundational learning, or academic English programs	4, 7

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
0-400 Hours*	*The following is just an outline of the possible topics covered in the course and a rough estimate of the time range that would be associated for a learner to learn that topic. Learners may not have to complete all topics listed. Topics selected at the discretion of the instructor based on learner needs assessment.
0-100 Hours	Listening: • Understand short social exchanges containing introductions, casual small talk and leave-taking. • Understand common, sequentially presented instructions and directions related to familiar, everyday situations of personal relevance. • Understand short communication intended to influence or persuade others in familiar, everyday situations. • Understand short descriptive or narrative communication on topics of personal relevance.
0-100 Hours	Speaking: • Use a range of courtesy formulas and some casual small talk in short, one-on-one or small group interactions. • Participate in very short, simple phone calls. • Give a set of simple, common, routine instructions and directions to a familiar person. [Instructions are about 4 to 5 steps.] • Make and respond to a range of requests and offers (such as getting assistance, and asking for, offering, accepting or rejecting goods or services.) • Ask for and give information about needs and feelings related to common everyday activities. • Give brief descriptions of personal experiences, situations or simple processes, such as getting goods or services.
0-100 Hours	Reading: • Understand simple personal social messages (such as invitations, thanks, apologies, quick updates and arrangements) within predictable contexts of daily experience. • Understand short, simple, clearly sequenced instructions and instructional texts for familiar everyday situations. [Instructions are up to about 6 steps in point form or as a short, continuous text that may include a visual to support comprehension.] • Get information from simple formatted texts (such as forms, tables, schedules and directories). • Get information from short business or service texts (such as brochures, notices, form letters and flyers). • Understand the purpose, main idea, key information and specific details in simple, short texts related to everyday familiar and personally relevant situations and topics. [Texts may be supported by graphics, charts, tables, illustrations or diagrams.] • Access simple standard reference texts (such as dictionaries and encyclopedias).
0-100 Hours	Writing: • Convey short, personal, informal social messages on topics related to familiar everyday situations (such as invitations, thanks, updates, cancellations and apologies). [Message is a few sentences or a short paragraph addressed to a familiar person and related to a personally relevant situation.] • Copy or record an expanded range of information from short texts for personal use. [Texts to copy are up to about 2 paragraphs and have a clear layout; can include passages, directories, schedules, instructions, directions, dictionaries and manuals; and may come from more than one source.] • Complete simple forms that require basic personal or familiar information and some responses to simple questions. [Forms contain about 15 to 20 items and have clear labels and areas in which to write.] • Write simple business or service messages. [Messages are about 7 sentences.] • Write a short paragraph to

	describe a familiar situation, event, personal experience or future plan. [Writing is about 1 paragraph.]

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-7	Portfolio-Based Language Assessment (PBLA) is utilized to assess and evaluate learners' progress in language learning. PBLA facilitates assessment for learning by documenting students' language learning over time, highlighting strengths and challenges, and providing frequent opportunities for feedback, reflection, self-assessment, and revision. A combination of formative and summative assessment is used to monitor learner progress against course outcomes. Testing occurs throughout the term. Instructor observations, anecdotal notes, marked work, portfolio assessment and summative testing all factor into the CLBs assigned at term end.	P/BD/F

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A grade of P is required to pass this course. Learners may be required to pass this course in order to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

Completion of course work and adherence to attendance policy determine final grade.

Please consult with the program area or the Bow Valley College website for further details.

GRADING SCHEME

Symbol	Description	Grade Point Value
P	Pass	N/A
F	Fail	N/A
BD	Basic/Developing (Foundational programming courses only)	N/A
CM	Complete	N/A
NCM	Not Complete	N/A

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

All learning materials will be provided by the instructor.

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

The Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLBs) include four strands, listening, speaking, reading, and writing. To go up a CLB in a strand, learners must successfully complete most of the criteria on the assessed tasks in that strand. To progress to the next level, your CLBs must go up in at least three strands. For example, if your CLBs go up in three or four strands, you may be eligible to progress to the next level. However, if your CLBs go up in two or fewer strands, you will continue in the same level next term.

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course section. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements.

You may use the recordings only for educational purposes and you must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission.

Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 33(c) of the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Alberta) to deliver academic programming, support learner flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. If you have any questions about the collection, disclosure, use, or protection of this information, please contact the College's Access and Privacy Officer at foip@bowvalleycollege.ca.